

# Peter Birchler

Economics B.Sc. (UZH) — empirical research, data analysis, writing

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## EDUCATION

Sept 2022 — expected July 2027
University of Zurich

### B.Sc. in Economics

Bachelor's thesis completed; one remaining course.

Completed 2026

### Bachelor's Thesis — *Detecting Collusion in Swiss Meat TRQ Auctions*

Compared two structurally identical Swiss import-quota auctions that show persistently divergent price levels, using a Kolmogorov–Smirnov test on the distribution of firms' market-share changes to screen for coordinated bidding. Found no statistical evidence of collusion; the price gap is instead explained by chronic under-subscription of licenses in the low-price auction.

2021
Zurich

### Matura

*MNG Rämibühl*

## EXPERIENCE

July — December 2023
University of Fribourg

### Tutor & Research Assistant

*Faculty of Management, Economics and Social Sciences*

Hand-collected archival data for a research project: reviewed *Amtsbücher* from several Swiss cantons and coded the type and title of every legislative change over a 50-year period.

## WRITING & RESEARCH

Ongoing

### Moderator & Quality Contributor

*r/AskEconomics*

Write answers and moderate submissions on the largest online community for in-depth economics Q&A.

May 2025
brchlr.ch

### Efficiently Assigning Bogey Teams

Mechanism-design analysis of the 2025 Counter-Strike Blast Bounty tournament, where lower-rated teams could pick their opponents. Shows the tournament's own matchmaking rule fails to maximise organiser utility, and derives a mechanism, that does.

March 2025
Substack

### Gary's Bad Economics

*BirchlerMuesli*

Long-form critique setting out where Gary Stevenson's master's thesis — the basis of much of his public economic commentary — breaks down.

## SKILLS & DOMAIN KNOWLEDGE

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|---|---|
| Methods | Econometrics · statistical screening · data collection and cleaning · technical writing |
| Software | Python · Stata · R · LaTeX |
| Competition economics | Cartel and collusion literature, with a focus on empirical detection and screening methods |
| Trade policy | Swiss and international tariff-rate-quota regimes |
| Languages | German (native) · English (native) · French (conversational) |
| Interests | Chess and team-based competitive games · NYT Crosswords, Basketball and Football |